

SOC INCIDENT ESCALATION | L2 → L3

File Reputation & Threat Intelligence Report

Subject: eicar.com — SHA-256 275a021b...651fd0f

Ticket / Case ID	SOC-2026-1002-EICAR-01 [replace with SIEM/ticket ID]
Report Date	02 October 2026, 18:30 UTC
Prepared by	Rahul Shrivastava — SOC Analyst (L2)
Escalated to	L3 Lead — SOC / Incident Response
Data Source	VirusTotal (Detection, Details, Relations, Behavior) — snapshot 02 Oct 2026, 18:24 UTC
Classification	TLP:AMBER — internal SOC distribution only
Priority (proposed)	P4 — Informational, conditional on parent-process validation (see §7)

BOTTOM LINE UP FRONT

Verdict: TRUE POSITIVE — BENIGN (test artifact). The hash is the industry-standard EICAR anti-malware test file. It is harmless, non-executable in any meaningful sense, and exists to confirm that AV/EDR engines are working.

Detection: 66 of 68 engines that processed the file flag it (EICAR signature); community reputation +3,797; known distributor OffSec (Kali Linux) and listed in NIST NSRL.

Why it still reached L3: VirusTotal records 3.7K execution parents, several of which are high-detection droppers (up to 64/72). The EICAR file is never the threat — its parent might be. Closure depends on validating what wrote it to our endpoint.

1. Executive Summary

An endpoint/EDR alert was raised for the file eicar.com (68 bytes). Hash enrichment through VirusTotal identifies the sample as the EICAR Standard Anti-Virus Test File, maintained by the European Institute for Computer Antivirus Research. Near-universal vendor detection is expected behaviour and confirms our security controls are functioning; it is not, by itself, evidence of compromise.

The analysis did surface one material consideration for L3: EICAR is frequently embedded in or dropped by other binaries — including genuinely malicious and evasive samples — to test or trip AV. The investigative pivot is therefore the process lineage on the affected host, not the file itself. If the drop is tied to an authorised activity (AV validation, red-team, Kali tooling, EDR health check), this case can be closed as benign. If the parent is unknown, the case should be re-scored and handled as a potential malware-delivery event.

2. Verdict & Classification

Attribute	Assessment
Alert disposition	True Positive (detection fired correctly) — Benign activity
Threat label (VT)	virus.eicar/test Family labels: eicar, test, file
Threat category (VT)	virus (15 engines), trojan (2 engines) — signature naming convention only

Attribute	Assessment
Actual risk of file	None — 68-byte ASCII test string, no payload, no persistence, no C2
Residual risk	Low-Medium, dependent on parent process / delivery vector (\$7)
Confidence	High (TrID 100% match, hash matches public EICAR reference, NSRL-listed)

3. File Identification

File name	eicar.com (also seen as eicar.txt, test.txt.txt, eicar.com-<n>)
File size	68 bytes
File type	EICAR antivirus test file (TrID 100%); VT type field shows "Powershell" — text-content misclassification, not a script
Magic	EICAR virus test files
SHA-256	275a021bbfb6489e54d471899f7db9d1663fc695ec2fe2a2c4538aabf651fd0f
SHA-1	3395856ce81f2b7382dee72602f798b642f14140
MD5	44d88612fea8a8f36de82e1278abb02f
SSDEEP	3:a+JraNvsgzsVqSwHq9:tJu0gzsko
TLSH	T141A022003B0EEE2BA20B00200032E8B00808020E2CE00A3820A020B8C83308803EC228
First seen (VT)	22 May 2006, 12:42 UTC
Last analysed (VT)	02 Oct 2026, 18:24 UTC
Times submitted	1,167,030 submissions from 3,557 unique sources

4. Reputation & Detection Analysis

4.1 Reputation Scorecard

Signal	Value	Interpretation
AV detection ratio	66 / 68	Expected — EICAR is designed to be detected
Undetected	2 (CrowdStrike, Acronis)	ML/behaviour engines often ignore inert test strings
Type-unsupported	7	BitDefenderFalx, tehtris, DeepInstinct, Trampoline, Paloalto, Cylance, Trustlook
Suspicious / Harmless / Timeout	0 / 0 / 0	No ambiguity across engines
VT community score	+3,797	Strongly positive (trusted)
Community votes	2,309 harmless vs 422 malicious	84.5% harmless
Known distributor	OffSec Services Limited	Shipped in Kali Linux, Kali Purple, NetHunter, BlackArch

Signal	Value	Interpretation
NSRL	Listed	NIST known-software reference set

4.2 Representative Vendor Verdicts

Vendors explicitly label the file as a non-threat test signature — a key differentiator from real malware naming.

Engine	Detection Name
Kaspersky / Ikarus	EICAR-Test-File
BitDefender / Arcabit / VIPRE	EICAR-Test-File (not a virus)
Avast	EICAR Test-NOT virus!!!
ESET-NOD32	Eicar test file
Sophos / Malwarebytes	EICAR-AV-Test
Symantec	EICAR Test String
Dr.Web	EICAR Test File (NOT a Virus!)
SUPERAntiSpyware	NotAThreat.EICAR[TestFile]
Tencent	EICAR.TEST.NOT-A-VIRUS
ClamAV	Eicar-Test-Signature
Cynet	Malicious (score: 99) — generic scoring, no family context

5. Threat Intelligence Enrichment

5.1 Crowdsourced Detection Content

Source	Rule / Result	Origin
YARA	malw_eicar	advanced-threat-research/Yara-Rules
YARA	Multi_EICAR_ac8f42d6	elastic/protections-artifacts
YARA	SUSP_Just_EICAR	Neo23x0/signature-base
Sigma	1 match — Low	Crowdsourced Sigma
IDS	1 match — Low	Crowdsourced IDS (EICAR string in transit)

5.2 Sandbox Verdicts

Sandbox	Verdict	Classification
Zenbox	Malicious	MALWARE / TROJAN — EICAR
Lastline	Malicious	MALWARE / TROJAN
OS X Sandbox	Malicious	MALWARE / TROJAN / EVADER — EICAR
Yomi Hunter	Harmless	CLEAN

Note: sandbox "malicious" verdicts are signature-driven (the EICAR string triggers the sandbox's own AV layer); they do not reflect observed malicious behaviour.

5.3 Behaviour Tags — Handle With Care

VirusTotal tags this hash with: powershell, attachment, via-tor, direct-cpu-clock-access, detect-debug-environment, long-sleeps, idle, known-distributor.

ANALYST CAUTION

Tags such as via-tor, long-sleeps and detect-debug-environment are aggregated from sandbox runs and from the execution context of parent samples. A 68-byte ASCII string cannot sleep, detect a debugger, or route traffic over Tor. These tags must NOT be attributed to the EICAR file in the case record; they are, however, a signal that some parents delivering EICAR are evasive.

6. Relations Analysis (VirusTotal → Relations tab)

Relationship	Count	Analyst Interpretation
Contacted Domains	30	Sandbox OS/CDN background traffic (Akamai, Apple, Microsoft MSN, Snapcraft, Adobe, Fastly). 29/30 clean; 1 domain at 1/91. Not attributable to EICAR.
Contacted IP addresses	110	Predominantly AS16509 (Amazon) and AS20940 (Akamai), US — 0/91 detections in sampled set. Environmental noise.
Execution Parents	3.7K	Files that wrote EICAR during sandbox execution. Mixed: benign test tools and genuinely malicious droppers. PRIMARY PIVOT.
PE Resource Parents	100	PE files embedding EICAR in their resources — common in AV-test utilities and evasive packers.
Dropped Files	84	Mach-O system artefacts from macOS sandbox runs (0/64). Not payloads.
Contained in Graphs	80	Referenced in community investigation graphs.
Comments / Votes	200 / 200	Community consensus: test file.

6.1 Notable Execution Parents (sampled)

Parent File Name	Type	Detections	Comment
bioj233a.exe	Win32 EXE	64 / 72	High-confidence malicious
augustus4.18-deobfuscated.zip	ZIP	55 / 65	Archive, high detection
z63h.za.com.exe	Win32 EXE	55 / 70	High-confidence malicious
XmqSACvRCBh.exe	Win32 EXE	49 / 72	Random name — loader pattern
我是病毒.exe ("I am a virus")	Win32 EXE	47 / 71	Likely test/joke binary
testeav.exe	Win32 EXE	46 / 71	AV-test utility
pdf-doc-vba-eicar-dropper.pdf	PDF	37 / 64	Document-based dropper (test)
make_eicar.py	Text / Python	6 / 61	Benign generator script
linux.sh	Shell script	0 / 62	Benign

Takeaway: the same EICAR hash is produced by both harmless test tooling and malware. The disposition of our alert is decided by which of these categories our parent process falls into.

7. Analyst Assessment & Key Findings

1. **Identity confirmed.** SHA-256, SHA-1 and MD5 match the published EICAR reference values; TrID returns a 100% EICAR match.
2. **No intrinsic threat.** 68-byte printable ASCII string, no code execution capability outside AV-triggering, no network, persistence or credential-access behaviour.
3. **Controls validated.** Detection by our EDR is a positive health signal — the control worked as designed.
4. **Behaviour tags are inherited noise.** via-tor / anti-debug / long-sleep tags originate from parent samples and sandbox context and must not be attributed to this file.
5. **Real risk sits upstream.** With 3.7K execution parents including droppers scored 49–64/72, an unexplained EICAR write can be a by-product of a malicious loader or an attacker probing AV coverage before deploying a real payload.

8. MITRE ATT&CK Context

No technique is attributable to the EICAR file itself. The following apply only if the parent process is confirmed unauthorised:

Technique	Name	Relevance
T1518.001	Security Software Discovery	Dropping EICAR to test whether AV/EDR responds
T1497	Virtualization/Sandbox Evasion	Parent-level anti-debug / long-sleep tags
T1090.003	Proxy: Multi-hop Proxy	Parent-level via-tor tag
T1105	Ingress Tool Transfer	If EICAR arrived via download alongside other files

9. Recommended Actions for L3

9.1 Immediate (validate & decide)

1. Pull process lineage from EDR for the write event (parent, grandparent, command line, user, signer).
2. Correlate with change/approval records: AV validation test, red-team / pentest window, Kali or security-tool usage, EDR health-check scripts.
3. Hash the parent binary and enrich in VirusTotal / TI platform; check for siblings written in the same second (EICAR + real payload is a known pattern).
4. Review the host for outbound Tor indicators and new persistence in the ± 30 -minute window.

9.2 Decision Matrix

Finding	Action
Parent is authorised test tooling	Close: True Positive – Benign. Document change reference. No containment.
Parent unknown but clean (0 detections)	Interview asset owner; keep open 24h; monitor host.
Parent malicious / unsigned / evasive	Re-score to P2, isolate host, collect triage image, open IR case, block parent hash.

9.3 Detection Engineering

- Do NOT globally allow-list the EICAR hash — doing so blinds AV-health monitoring and hides attacker AV-probing.
- Create a scoped suppression for approved test hosts / service accounts only, with an expiry date.

- Add an enrichment rule: when EICAR is detected, auto-attach parent-process hash reputation to the alert to cut triage time.

10. Indicators (defanged)

Type	Value
SHA-256	275a021bbfb6489e54d471899f7db9d1663fc695ec2fe2a2c4538aabbf651fd0f
SHA-1	3395856ce81f2b7382dee72602f798b642f14140
MD5	44d88612fea8a8f36de82e1278abb02f
File name	eicar[.]com
Sandbox domain (1/91)	cl-glcb907925[.]gcdn[.]co – environmental, low confidence, monitor only

Blocking recommendation: none for the EICAR hash itself. Block decisions apply to the parent process if confirmed malicious.

11. Evidence & References

- **VirusTotal report:**
<https://www.virustotal.com/gui/file/275a021bbfb6489e54d471899f7db9d1663fc695ec2fe2a2c4538aabbf651fd0f>
- **EICAR test file specification:** <https://www.eicar.org/>
- **MITRE ATT&CK:** <https://attack.mitre.org/>

ANALYST SIGN-OFF

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Status: Escalated — awaiting L3 parent-process validation and closure decision.